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A long road to a dream

An Ailey dance program (in NYC) is worth any sacrifice for a teen and her mother



‘I was like, “Oh my gosh, is this my child?” She just looked so stunning and confident, like it was just natural.’

NATALYA BAINE *on watching her daughter Nasya perform*



PHOTOS BY PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Natalya and Nasya Baine have been making the trip to New York City from Boston four times a week over the past few months so that Nasya can train at the renowned Ailey School. Stories of relentlessly dedicated dancers and the families who support them no matter the cost are commonplace at Ailey.

By Alyssa Vaughn
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

By now, Natalya Baine and her daughter Nasya have their routine down pat.

Four days a week, Natalya wakes up, cooks lunch and dinner, then stores the meals in to-go containers as 17-year-old Nasya packs up and gets dressed. They load their belongings into their car — the food, Nasya’s dance shoes and clothes, Natalya’s homework for her master’s program — make a quick stop at BJ’s for gas, call Natalya’s mother to say a prayer, and are on the road by late morning.

By 4:30, they’ve arrived at their destination: the Joan Weill Center in Manhattan, home of the renowned Ailey School, where Nasya is enrolled in the company’s pre-professional school year program. She takes ballet and modern classes at the Ailey studios for three hours, then returns to the car, where her mother has been waiting. Natalya puts the keys in the ignition. They’re back home in Dorchester by midnight.

This has been the drill for Natalya and Nasya every Tuesday, Thursday, Friday, and Saturday (except they start earlier on Saturday) since Nasya began the Ailey program last September. Financially and logistically, a move, even temporarily, to New York City for the dura-

AILEY, Page A10

Jewish students say bias less of an issue

Many at Harvard believe antisemitism has eased since height of Gaza protests

By Hilary Burns and Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

Jewish students at Harvard find themselves at the center of a storm.

For a year and a half, influential alumni, national politicians, the international media, and now the president of the United States have been pointing to Jewish students as the primary victims of what they see as the rot at the core of American universities.

In their telling, leftist ideology, and its antipathy to Israel, have created a breeding ground for rampant antisemitism that has forced many Jewish students to live in fear.

But many Jewish students at Harvard, including those concerned about antisemitism on elite campuses, say this political narrative distorts their experiences.

Interviews with more than a dozen Jewish students and recent graduates, and half a dozen Harvard alumni, faculty, and staff, found that many felt the climate has shifted significantly since the height of the Gaza war protests a year ago. Then, Jewish students were regularly confronted with offensive slogans and rhetoric around campus and online, experienced social shunning from peers, and reported incidents of bias and hate.

HARVARD, Page A6

In shift, DA faults judge, not ICE agent

Hayden says Summerville’s contempt finding was illegal

By Dan Glaun
GLOBE STAFF

Suffolk District Attorney Kevin Hayden has declined to bring contempt charges against the Immigration and Customs Enforcement agent who arrested a man in the middle of his trial last month — and instead issued a scathing rebuke to the Boston judge who ordered the investigation.

Hayden said in a 10-page report released Thursday that Judge Mark Summerville’s contempt finding against the ICE agent “was without adequate factual or legal basis and barred by the Supremacy Clause of the United States Constitution.”

The report was a downshift for Hayden. In the immediate aftermath of the incident, he had vowed to investigate Summerville’s finding and expressed similar concerns that the ICE agent had interfered with the local justice system, calling his actions “extraordinarily reckless” and harmful to public safety. But while Hayden said Thursday that he remained troubled by ICE’s actions, he faulted Summerville for pushing the investigation in the first place.

“This office finds that criminal charges based upon Judge Summerville’s patently illegal contempt finding and referral are not warranted,” Hayden wrote.

Summerville found ICE agent Brian Sullivan in contempt for detaining defendant Wilson Mar-

HAYDEN, Page A6

SNAP thefts leave families at a loss

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Dawn Hines had just finished a quick grocery run when she realized all the SNAP funds had been drained from her card — \$608 gone in the 10 minutes it took to get through the checkout line at the Braintree Stop & Shop, walk back to her car, and check her account.

Hines’s family is one of thousands of low-income Massachusetts families that collectively have had millions of dollars in Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program funds stolen in recent months. The theft of SNAP benefits, formerly known as food stamps, has become a national epidemic in recent years, fueled by suspected crime rings using skim-

mers on retail card readers to access electronic benefits cards.

Since December, when federal funding to replace stolen SNAP money was halted, families have been left without the help they rely on to put food on the table. And massive funding cuts to the SNAP program being discussed by the Trump administra-

THEFTS, Page A10

Many T escalators still out of step

With some down for years, accessibility is an issue

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

After walking through the turnstile at Aquarium Station, 85-year-old Joan Taylor glanced up at the seemingly never-ending flight of stairs, and the neighboring defunct escalators cordoned off by yellow barricades with “do not enter” warnings. She clasped the silver cross dangling from her neck.

“I don’t wanna do them,” said Taylor, who has problems with her knees.

She was visiting from Canada with her daughter and granddaughter on a recent weekday. They elected to wait for the elevator to take them up to

Atlantic Avenue. Many other Blue Line riders did the same, including nannies with small children in tow on their way to the New England Aquarium.

But not everyone had time to spare. A handful of travelers, rushing to Logan Airport, strained to heave their luggage down all 61 steps, occasionally stopping to collect themselves.

On a daily basis, closed escalators at MBTA stations pose accessibility issues and headaches for passengers, leaving them with the option to climb the stairs — a sweat-inducing workout for some, and a painful task for those with mobility challenges — or spend precious time waiting in line for an elevator, if one is available.

While certain issues can be fixed within a day, others that require major work or new parts can

ESCALATORS, Page A5



JEFF ROBERSON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

NO. 4 IS NO. 1 — The Patriots chose LSU’s Will Campbell, a left tackle, with the fourth pick overall in the NFL Draft on Thursday night. **C1.**

Federal immigration officials must transport Rümeysa Öztürk back to Vermont, a federal judge ruled after the government continued fighting to keep her in Louisiana. **B1.**

Russia killed 12 people and injured 90 others in a huge attack on Kyiv, prompting President Trump to issue a rare critique of Moscow. **A3.**

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth reportedly had an unsecured internet connection in his office to use the Signal messaging app. **A2.**

What goes up

Friday: Some sun, warm. High 68-73. Low 53-58.

Saturday: Showers, cool. High 59-64. Low 46-51.

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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